LALIT TAK

Product Manager | Technical Product Manager | B2B Platforms, IoT & Smart Metering (HES, MDMS, Prepaid)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI-augmented Technical Product Manager with ~5 years in energy-tech and enterprise software. Currently SDE-3 Team Lead at Polaris Smart Metering, owning product lifecycle for HES, MDMS, Prepaid and production-automation platforms. Conceived and shipped Merak, FIT and SNM — 0-to-1 AI-native internal products adopted across engineering and production teams. Led 14 engineers; lifted on-time delivery from ~60% to 90%+, cut cycle time by 40% and deployment effort by 60%+. Combines technical depth (Python, SQL, REST APIs) with GenAI co-strategist workflows and prompt engineering. Pursuing the ICPM, including a Generative AI Co-Strategist module, from the Institute of Product Leadership, USA.

CORE PRODUCT MANAGEMENT SKILLS

Product: AI-First Product Strategy, Product Roadmap, Product Lifecycle Management, Product Discovery, PRD / BRD, User Stories, Requirement Gathering, Backlog Prioritisation (RICE, MoSCoW, Kano), MVP Definition, North Star Metrics, OKR/KPI, PLG, GTM Strategy, A/B Testing, Customer Discovery, User Personas, Journey Mapping

Delivery: Agile / Scrum, Sprint Planning, Backlog Grooming, Release Management, Dependency Management, RCA & CAPA, SLA-driven Issue Triage, Quality Gates, Cross-functional Leadership

AI & Data: GenAI Co-Strategist, Prompt Engineering, LLM-Powered Workflows, Intelligent Automation, Data-Driven Decision Making, ML-Driven Insights, Operational Analytics

Domain: Smart Metering, AMI, IoT Devices, Head-End Systems (HES), MDMS, Prepaid Metering, Manufacturing / NPI, B2B Enterprise Platforms, Energy Tech

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Polaris Smart Metering Pvt. Ltd., Jaipur Dec 2024 – Present

SDE-3 Team Lead (product and engineering lead for HES, MDMS, Prepaid and production automation)

- **Product ownership:** End-to-end lifecycle across HES, MDMS, Prepaid and production-automation workstreams: PRDs, user stories, roadmap, milestones, releases and stakeholder sign-off for a 1,000+ device smart meter deployment.
- **0-to-1 AI-native product:** Conceived and shipped Merak (Polagram Intelligence Platform), a live operational-intelligence web product surfacing real-time data and streamlining cross-team workflows for engineering and product teams.
- **Problem to product:** Built the Field Issue Tracker (FIT) — Jira-integrated, 7-stage lifecycle (Draft → Closed), RBAC, automated status sync and email alerts; adopted by 20+ team members tracking 100+ field issues.
- **Manufacturing platform:** Defined and delivered Serial Number Management (SNM) — production-grade serial generation, tracking and lifecycle management; RBAC, batch generation, audit trails, multi-format export (CSV/JSON/Excel).
- **Release management:** Own the R&D-to-NPI release gate, coordinating firmware, HES, BCS and hardware sign-offs across 6+ stakeholders; prevented 3+ major delivery slippages per quarter.
- **Process product:** Designed SLA-driven production triage (Critical: 2h, High: 4h) with structured RCA and CAPA; adopted across Production, QA and R&D.
- **Intelligent automation:** Institutionalised a 5-phase automation dev & validation workflow with quality gates and Git-based control — 60%+ deployment cycle cut, zero unreviewed scripts in production.
- **Team leadership:** Led 14 engineers via Agile/Scrum and JIRA; on-time delivery 60% → 90%+; requirement-to-implementation cycle time cut by 40%.

Secure Meters Ltd., Udaipur Sep 2021 – Oct 2024

Software Engineer (smart metering projects: Banswara, Bhilwara and Bihar deployments)

- Delivered features and updates for utility smart metering projects across HES, MDMS and Prepaid systems at 10,000+ device scale with 99%+ data accuracy.
- Gathered and clarified requirements with cross-functional teams; translated into solution designs and dev plans.
- Managed PostgreSQL databases and ETL pipelines (Pentaho/Kettle); optimised DB performance and resolved data issues.
- Wrote test plans; ran regression, integration and UAT; automated manual test cases with AutoIT to reduce effort.
- Eliminated 15+ engineering hours/week through data-driven automation of manual validation workflows.
- Reduced post-release production incidents by 30% through improved system integration and regression testing.

Industrial Traineeships 2014 – 2018

BHEL · JDVVNL (Jodhpur) · HNG Float Glass Ltd. · RVPN (Rajasthan Vidyut Prasaran Nigam)

- Foundation in electrical systems, industrial automation and large-scale operations management.

SELECTED PRODUCTS & PROJECTS

- **Merak, Polagram Intelligence Platform:** Live operational-intelligence platform; real-time data and cross-team workflow surface for engineering and product teams (merak.polagram.in).
- **Field Issue Tracker (FIT):** Jira-integrated issue lifecycle product (React/FastAPI) that replaced manual handoffs; 20+ users, 100+ issues tracked.
- **Serial Number Management (SNM):** Serial generation and lifecycle management for meter manufacturing with RBAC, audit trails and CSV/JSON/Excel export (snm.polagram.in).
- **R&D-to-NPI Release Gate:** Multi-stakeholder checklist ensuring all deliverables close before a product reaches manufacturing.
- **5-Phase Automation Dev & Validation Workflow:** Quality gates, technical review, SOP compliance, Git version control; 60%+ deployment cycle cut.

EDUCATION

M.Tech, Power System Engineering, NIT Surat (SVNIT) 2019 – 2021
CGPA 8.50 / 10

B.Tech, Electrical Engineering, MBM Engineering College (MBM University), Jodhpur 2016 – 2019
CGPA 7.84 / 10

Diploma, Electrical Engineering, Board of Technical Education, Rajasthan 2013 – 2015
76.55%

CERTIFICATIONS & PUBLICATIONS

- **International Certificate in Product Management (ICPM),** Institute of Product Leadership, USA (In progress, Nov 2026): PM fundamentals, product design, Agile PM, GTM strategy, data-driven products, Generative AI Co-Strategist.
- Fundamentals of Project Planning and Management, Univ. of Virginia (Coursera) 2020; Effective Problem-Solving, UC Irvine 2020; Machine Learning for All, Univ. of London 2020.
- 7 peer-reviewed papers and book chapters (IEEE, Springer) on smart grids, AMI, cybersecurity in energy systems and reliability engineering.

TOOLS & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Product & Delivery: JIRA, Figma, Balsamiq, Miro, MS Visio, Excel, Mixpanel, Google Analytics, Whimsical
Engineering & Data: Python, SQL, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, ETL (Pentaho/Kettle), JavaScript, Git/GitHub, CI/CD, Linux, Bash, AutoIT
AI: Generative AI / LLM tools, Prompt Engineering, OpenAI (GPT-4), Claude (Anthropic), Gemini